

Dream Tapestries

Louise Morey Bowman

Dream Tapestries

Louise Morey Bowman

The Project Gutenberg eBook of Dream tapestries

This eBook is for the use of anyone anywhere in the United States and most other parts of the world at no cost and with almost no restrictions whatsoever. You may copy it, give it away or re-use it under the terms of the Project Gutenberg License included with this eBook or online at www.gutenberg.org. If you are not located in the United States, you will have to check the laws of the country where you are located before using this eBook.

Title: Dream tapestries

Author: Louise Morey Bowman

Release date: March 14, 2023 [eBook #70284]

Language: English

Original publication: Canada: The MacMillan Company of Canada, Limited, 1924

Other information and formats: www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/70284

Credits: Charlene Taylor, Krista Zaleski and the Online Distributed Proofreading Team at <https://www.pgdp.net> (This file was produced from images generously made available by The Internet Archive)

*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK DREAM
TAPESTRIES ***

Dream Tapestries

Dream Tapestries

by

Louise Morey Bowman

Author of "Moonlight and Common Day"

"Reason has moons, but moons not hers
Lie mirrored in her sea,
Confounding her astronomers
But, oh! delighting me."

(Ralph Hodgson)

TORONTO: THE MACMILLAN COMPANY OF CANADA LIMITED,
AT ST. MARTIN'S HOUSE MCMXXIV

Copyright, Canada, 1924
by The Macmillan Company of Canada Limited, Toronto

Printed in Canada

TO
ARCHIBALD ABERCROMBY BOWMAN

I wish to acknowledge the courtesy of the editors of *Poetry* (Chicago), *The Bookman* (New York), *The Canadian Forum*, and *The Canadian Magazine*, in permitting me to reprint “Cold Tragedy,” “Bread and Fire,” “Moment Musical,” “Blue Moon,” and “Oranges.”

CONTENTS

	PAGE
THE WINGÉD CLOAK	<u>11</u>
DREAM TAPESTRIES	
HYACINTH	<u>15</u>
ENCHANTED WOOD	<u>16</u>
GREEN APPLES	<u>19</u>
ORANGES	
ORANGES	<u>25</u>
THE MOUNTAIN THAT WATCHED	
THE MOUNTAIN THAT WATCHED	<u>33</u>
THE OLD FRUIT GARDEN	<u>40</u>
SONGS OF WOMEN	
BLUE MOON	<u>45</u>
MISTRESS MARY	<u>46</u>
DAFFY-DOWN-DILLY	<u>47</u>
THE BIRTH-NIGHT	<u>48</u>
A PORTRAIT	<u>50</u>
THE SONG OF THE WILLOW WAND	<u>52</u>
THE DEAD VIOLIN	<u>54</u>
A SKETCH	<u>57</u>

CINQUAINS

CITY CHILD’S EASTER	<u>61</u>
DEEP SNOW	<u>62</u>
TWELVE HOKKU ON A CANADIAN THEME	<u>64</u>
LIFE SEQUENCE (In the Hokku Manner)	<u>66</u>
PRAYER IN SCARLET AND WHITE PAINT	<u>67</u>
COLD TRAGEDY	
COLD TRAGEDY	<u>71</u>
HOMESPUN	
TWINS	<u>75</u>
BOB COONING	<u>80</u>
SYMPATHY	<u>84</u>
FALSE DAWN	<u>85</u>
THE WITCH	<u>86</u>
THE POST BOX	<u>88</u>
SONG	<u>89</u>
BREAD AND FIRE	<u>90</u>
“MOMENT MUSICAL”	<u>91</u>

THE WINGÉD CLOAK

*I DRAW my cloak about me ...
Tattered and gray
To others it may be.
It seems to me
Of golden hue,
Broidered with mystic blue,
Woven each dawn anew,
And light as dew-ringed cobweb
On the grass.
Unscathed and joyously
In it I pass
Through drenching torrent, wind,
Fierce pitiless sun,
Till day is done.*

Dream Tapestries

(1)
HYACINTH

HYACINTH dreams in the arbour ...
Just a crumpled mass of gray ...
Soft ashen hair and colourless skin,
Small, delicate hands blue-veined and thin ...
Hyacinth dreams in the arbour
And who shall say
What Hyacinth dreams to-day?

Hyacinth dreams in the arbour
And the stealthy pussy-cat creeps
To her silken lap in the soft green gloom.
Room for the pussy-cat, Hyacinth ... room!
Hyacinth dreams, in the arbour,
Of Life ... that steals and leaps
Like a panther out of the shadows ...
Hyacinth sleeps.

Hyacinth! Hyacinth! Open your eyes!
Your blue blue eyes like the Grecian seas!
Or Life will spring on your silken knees
And waken you with a wild surprise
Where you dream ... just a crumpled mass of gray.
Hyacinth dreams in the arbour.
Ah who shall say
What Hyacinth dreams to-day?

(2)
ENCHANTED WOOD

THROUGH the great glowing forest,
Green and dusky gold and ruddy brown,
Where sunbeams filter down
In showers of vibrant gold ...
Through the old, old wood
Passes the funeral pomp of the young, dead king.
Choristers sing
Strange, wailing, shuddering songs ...
Old chants, so old,
So desolate, drear.
Heavy, deep, purple velvet drapes the bier ...
Purple ... deep, passionate purple ...
A regal pall
Over the cold, young limbs, while the gold leaves fall
On the velvet pall.
On through the old wood moves
The great procession;
Deep, passionate purple draping the young, dead king;
And the choristers sing ...
And a small brown hare,
Startled, in quivering panic, scurries ahead
Leading the way for the king ...
The king who is dead.

In a bright green dell
Where they can see well,
Wait the butcher, the baker,
The candlestick maker.
“No more bread for he!”
Says the baker.
“No more meat for he!”
Says the butcher.

But the candlestick maker slaps his knee.
“Not such a bad day this for me!
No more meat and no more bread,
But candles to burn at his feet and his head.
Nor the living nor dead
Can’t get on without me!
And very very soon they’ll summon us three!”
“For the Feast!” grins the butcher
Wagging his head.
“For the Feast!” says the baker,
“They’ll soon need bread!”
“Men can’t do without we!”
They say, all three.
So the butcher, the baker,
The candlestick maker,
Watch the procession from the small green dell
Where they can all three see
Exceedingly well.

So the procession
Passed through the wood to the blue sea shore,
And they buried the king
Where the blue waves sing ...
And the young king rules no more.
But late that night through the lonely wood
Came a slim brown maid who had understood,
And mated her soul with the young, dead king,
With never a priest or mass or ring ...
And she carried a dagger with poisoned tip,
And pressed its point to her soft red lip ...
And she lay on the grave, and died.

Still at the turn of the year, men say,
Through the old, old forest in ghostly pageant
The funeral procession passes
Of the young, young king
Who is dead:

And the gold leaves fall
On his passionate purple pall,
And the small brown hare still scurries ahead
As if she were leading them all.

(3)
GREEN APPLES

THE garden lies spattered with wet green moonlight
Spilled from the night's dark goblet;
And the wraith in the garden huddles mournfully
Silently watching,
Upon the broad marble seat,
Where white lilies and roses bloom.
Wine of pale silver-green drenches the garden.
The little gray wraith huddles mournfully,
Silently watching.

.

On that broad marble seat to-day
Sat a beautiful lady ...
Through the hot golden hours of the long afternoon ...
Oh a beautiful lady!
With a warm wicked beauty of white, and of rose,
And of ebony.
Over her white breasts a long green scarf falling ...
Wet, bright, apple-green.
Out in the orchard, laughing
With clear, evil laughter ...
Ice laughter ...
She had gathered some little green apples
And bit them with strong white teeth.
“I am Eve! I am Eve in the garden ...
Come! Adam!”
And he followed ... poor, passionate lover ...
To the seat by the heavy white lilies and roses.
(Oh far far away lie the wise castle windows
Behind the rose gardens and lime trees!)
But after the lovers ... after them, swiftly, swiftly,

Like a fleeting gray shadow,
Speeds the little gray wraith ...
With feeble weak fingers of dampness
Pulling with tremulous touch at his heart-strings ...
Pricking like impotent tiny thorns;
Nipping, and pinching, and pricking
The shrivelled, black conscience of the rosy and beautiful lady.
See! from the shrivelled black conscience
One drop of bright, red blood,
As from prick of a rose thorn ...
And his heart-strings are drawn tight and knotted
With tiny, weak, slipping knots
Tied by feeble, damp fingers ...
Slipping ... slipping ... oh slipping!
But what does that matter?
For Time has come to the help of the gray wraith ...
Grave, gray Father Time with a handful of moments—
Dust? Ashes?...
He has set the rose-shrouded sundial in shadow.

.

Now the broad marble seat is empty
Except where gray wraith has sunk down in the moonlight
Victorious.
Ah! ... the lady had dropped her bright, apple-green scarf,
And it stirs like a sinuous, long snake.
Is it only that one pointed corner is lifted
By the stealthy, stealing, night wind?
Slowly, slowly ... so feebly ...
The snake lifts itself with the wind's help,
Revealing
A little green apple,
With some black dents where strong white teeth
Have bitten it.
And the small, gray wraith noiselessly moans and shudders.
But what matter?

For the long night passes.
Only the green scarf lies harmlessly, softly,
On the empty marble seat where the little gray wraith sits
And watches,
Victorious ...
Though the green wine of moonlight is drenching
The perilous garden.

Oranges

ORANGES

A SMALL New England village in the hills: ...
The date?
Oh, many, many years ago ... the season very late ...
November!
The conquering colours that a year must always hold
Have vanished.
Pale Northern Spring in tints of lilac, softest green and rose;
The short hot Summer's purple and dark green and yellow gold;
The tawny richness of the harvest's close ...
All past and vanquished in this sullen cold,
By sombre grays and browns, dead white and black.
The tall-spired meeting-house, the school,
The stiff white houses built by rigid rule,
Even the village store,
With hospitable, easily-opened door;
And their human owners reared in godly fear,
Austere, repressed,
Severe ...
How it all lies, before our modern eyes,
So grim.
Dressed in that rigid livery of nature's gloom that suits it best.
Hear their stern hymn ...
Dignified, slow,
Sung in proud, solemn majesty of menace and woe.
"Our days as grass ... all earth is but a tomb" ...
What unfathomed gloom ...
Smouldering!

(2)

Keen bitter winds have stripped the great elm trees,
And swept the one long street
Ruthlessly neat;

Quite bare of all the withered, dead, brown leaves,
Except for small dry heaps that meet,
Trembling and mournfully rustling,
Caught
In the corners of the neat, white, picket fences;
Or drifting
Behind the pillars in the porch of the white meeting-house,
Unused through the long week
Except for Death.
How the winds shriek about the meeting-house!
(But wait before you shudder and turn away!)
With the keen, icy breath of the New England hills
Sharp in your nostrils,
Step over the threshold of the village store,
With its easily-opened door.
Breathe this different air,
Heavy with curiously mingled odours
As if another wind had blown in there
Heaps of rare
Drifted salvage ...
Some wild, rich wind from wild rich worlds beyond,
That folk cannot entirely withhold,
Even from a Puritan village long ago.
Beware ... ye righteous folk of old ...
Beware!

(3)

Here are great foreign boxes, wisely and deftly made,
That hold teas from the Orient, compactly laid;
And coffee beans.
Here spices, pungent and hot;
Tall, blue-wrapped cones of sugar; fine and coarse salt;
And finest quality of figured delaine;
Dark, serviceable calico dotted and plain;
Sheer delicate muslin, white as milk,
And thick black silk;

And broadcloth heavy and black;
And much, much more ...
Of quantity and quality no lack—
For this is the “general store,” of a prosperous man
Old and wealthy and wise,
In the village eyes.
Oh, Puritan New England would be clothed fittingly;
And Puritan palates know,
Both high and low
The wholesome savour of good food
When in the mood;
As well as very fine
Flavours in sermons by some “great divine;”
Or savour of ethics proved and tried,
And flavours in doctrines never very wide ...
But high and pure ...
(That you’ll acknowledge!)
God ... but they were sure ...
Those grim fine people of ours! ... another hymn ...
“Only such things as are godly and pure,
Saved from consuming wrath they shall endure.”...
Is that the echo of the bell
From the tall-spired white meeting-house?
Its bell is silent through the week, except for Death ...
Hear the wind shriek about the meeting-house!
But this small bell
Fastened above the door
Of the old village store,
Tinkles continually, where through the week,
They barter and buy and sell.

(4)

(In this short passing hour we shall see more ...)
He is a man of vision and breadth of mind ...
This storekeeper.
Back in the dusky depths of the old store

Are rows of books in sober black and brown;
Books for his town
That are not all volumes of sermons or hymns,
Or a "Garland of Sacred Poetry from Friend to Friend."
(Does not some stern voice ask "Where will this end?")
For here are books of perilous voyages, tales of human ways,
And human lives, and of the great, historic, coloured days
Of far-off empires ... Ah ... here are William Shakespeare's mighty plays!
(But we must not stop to read more titles now ... the hour is almost past)
Daylight is fading fast ...
And heaped on the dark, well-rubbed old counter lies his last
And latest venture on seas of commerce ...
Oranges!

(5)

Oranges ... oranges ...
Great balls of golden wonder ... round, perishable globes ...
Here a ripe pyramid most carefully laid
Beside sad-toned materials for matrons' robes,
And piles of iron-gray wool for their men's winter stockings ...
Plain comfortable sight ... proof against sharp frost bite
Of the Northern Winters.
See how the oranges have caught up all the light!
What joyous tones they hold
Of vivid, bold,
Hot colour!
They glow like balls moulded of molten gold.
Above them from the rafters hang thin strings and strings,
Innumerable strings
Of dull, dried apples!
Nothing is here akin to the oranges at all ...
Nothing in all
This colourless, inanimate hoard ... nothing's akin
Except that vague, enduring richness, so alluring,
That we smell,
When the small bell,

Over the door tinkles ... and we come in ...
Out of the keen, pure coldness of the wind.

(6)

So ... the scene is set ... for good and ill.
Over the highest hill
New winds blow wild and shrill:
For “the old order changeth” still.
Who now is sure what shall endure?
The street is empty ... in the dusky store,
Holding the eye with a voluptuous lure,
The oranges burn through the smouldering gloom.

The Mountain That Watched

THE MOUNTAIN THAT WATCHED

“IN the beginning” ... “The heavens and the earth” ...
“Let there be light” ...
After all we can’t improve on Genesis
After all we can’t improve on Genesis
For the condensed beginning of a tale!
But earth is much more earth, and heaven much more heaven
When it’s our own old Mountain, touching sky
Like this, right up in the middle of the island,
Than when it’s a mountain range across the oceans.
That’s to my way of thinking anyhow.
Mountain and city ... Edinburgh now ... but that’s another’s story ...
Sonnet form!
And now ... to mine, to-day.
To-day! To-day is written in curling smoke
Before the Mountain, dumb above the city ...
Our Mountain ... trying to make us understand,
By secret code, sign language ... what you will.

*Rustling of leaves—
Pale green, dark amber, scarlet, crimsoning brown—
Deep coloured sighs and long deep breaths of earth—
Rustling of leaves—*

“In the beginning”—
The river, the island, and the rustling leaves,
Arrows and mating and life and birth and death,
Silence and solitude;
But always the Mountain, touching cold blue sky
When the white men landed in their little boats,
When holy dreaming men and women came,
And built their funny little forts and towers,
And sacred shrines,
And made a new-world city.

And all the while the Mountain watched and watched.

Dirt? Well you certainly can't expect a city's docks,
or a great station at an entrance port,
to be like a Quaker meeting-house
on a seventh-day noon.

Docks! There's a magical word! Not unpoetical
let me tell you, if you'll only close your eyes
and use that "inward eye" your Wordsworth used
for daffodils. My God! you'd think he had secured that "eye"
to be hereafter used for "daffodils," and "solitude" and "thrills,"
exclusively!

Come now! Just try it on for once to-day
with river docks filled with the motley throng ...
old world and new.

Deep searching eyes that seek the "golden West"—
wild eyes that hold the primal hunger lure,
young eyes that hold the secrets of the dawn,
sad eyes that hold the fury of the night—
We'll have to stand the dirty docks I think,
and the crowded station—

holding a daffodil to your nose to smell
you'll soon forget the nose and the daffodil!

What's that you're murmuring?

"It's all like a magic casement opening out
on perilous seas...." Bless you for those kind words!
Though that's John Keats that sees our docks—not you!

Wait just a moment—here is something now
that's well worth watching! It's the Jewish New Year,
and those are orthodox Jews who have come down
to cast their sins away in running water.

Mumbling in their beards ... from books, and some from memory ...
punctilious enough they are ...

shaking their overcoats ... (those two men, look!)

Into deep river ... old Father St. Lawrence running to the sea.

Old men, believers—and a few young ones too.

You see? Turn round and look at the motor cars.
Look at that old old woman from the slums—
Grandmother of Isaac and Jacob and Abraham—
Look at her! Carefully shake, shake, shake, old Mother!
Strong, wrinkled, kindly face—those toil-worn hands—
Come, let us try the “inward eye” again....
Verily—see! Her sins do drop and float away from her
on the dirty oily water—little sins
that float like tiny, bright-red maple leaves
cast from a lusty old tree in the Fall.
She’s known the life of the full ripe seasons through ...
carefully and punctiliously shake, shake, shake!
Let us go too from the docks with lightened hearts,
groping our way on upward through the slums.
Listen to the lilt and whimsical chattering
of alien tongues.
“And have not charity”—“Through a glass darkly” ... see?
We’ve dropped our classic daffodils and trod
upon them! But we’ve really seen—something.
To-day.
What else does the Mountain see?
Churches! Hotels! Domes, palaces and towers,
Steep hilly streets, shops, hovels, factories.
Limestone tradition!
Romance! Romance! Raw gold!
Merry-men, jesters, in a surging crowd
mingling with Holy Folk—
Miracles, shrines, and glorious, honest doubts—
raw gold, black, red,—
new thoughts breed sacraments—
white dreams and tawny sins—
the half-good, the half-bad—Humanity!
Groping humanity—
Who judges? How? Or why?
The Mountain watches.

Snow-dusted silent streets. The midnight mass—

with quiet thronging worshippers that pass
from darkness into glimmering ecstasies.—

Another mood ...

The blizzard—

The swirling wall-like drifts, while through the streets
the snow-ploughs move like huge primeval beasts
glutted with power;
wallowing through the mists of drifting powdery particles,
ploughing the snow.

The Mountain watches and possesses now
a festival afternoon of sparkling white,
pierced by the thrilling flights of vivid glancing skis—
pierced by the shooting downward in death-like dive,
of flat toboggans on the mountain slide.
Impertinence the Mountain tolerates!

The flashing facets of an ice palace
reared in a square beside a towering church of massive stone,
for half a continent to gaze upon if it so desires,
and feast between whiles.

(“H-mmm—Good advertising this—

Hush! Watch your step! Deliver the goods!”)

Ah well—Mount Royal, graven on a “souvenir!”

The Mountain watches.

“Truly an ice palace is a beautiful thing—a fairy tale!”

“You poets are so fantastic!” “You should worry!”

“My word I’m nearly dead for tea!” “Do hurry!”

“Ice plants for making artificial ice”—“Efficiency”—

“Gold seal—good jazz”

“The cafeterias are the thing to-day—

take up your tray

and walk!”

“What blasphemy!”

“Ice plants for making artificial ice”

“Fine bargain furs there if you’ve got the price”

“Gods! what a day!”

Then much the same in French—the rapid glancing tongue.

“Day uttereth speech” indeed.
“Night sheweth knowledge.”
The Mountain watches.
Night! Zero night—
like a dense black velvet skin
drawn tightly over the city;
and lights pricking, pricking, pricking—
like fiery pin-points in a million eyes
behind black skins, blazing with jungle light ...
a gay old city is sinister at night.

*Rustling and creaking of black naked branches
On the old Mountain—
Stark twisted branches black against the snow
Snapping and crackling of frost-tortured trees—
Rustling—*

Something has happened! The Mountain almost seems to tremble.
Down its sides rush the melting snows in torrents;
tumbling, tumultuous, most untidy rivers
through icy blackened parapets that still stand.
Washing day for the Mountain!
Ah but wait!—
Silver-green city in a rosy mist—Spring dawn!—
As Life has waked with a soft stirring
Of pouting leafy lips
And curling velvet finger-tips,
Through all the ages while the Mountain watched.

*Rustling of leaves—
Silver-green, rose-red, amber, scarlet, brown—
Deep coloured sighs and long deep breaths of earth—
Rustling of leaves—*

Against my hand a little crumbling dust
Is softly blown—
Before my eyes a glory—sunset? Dawn?
And in my ears a great triumphant song—

Is it a song?
Or but the quiet breathing of a child
Who holds its coloured toys and drifts to sleep?

The Mountain watches and is very still.

THE OLD FRUIT GARDEN

MEMORY

THROUGH tortured weeks of hospital surgery
The old fruit garden of my childhood days
Grew close about me. Through black storms of pain
Swayed joyous boughs of rosy apple-bloom;
White blossomed branches of an old plum-tree;
Old grape-vines clinging to a sunny wall;
Great bushes of red currants and raspberries.
Through hours of torturing thirst I found again
That old fruit garden—as if body and soul
Clutched at cool juicy fruits—remembering—
Devouring them through a parched mouth of the brain.

GRAPES

Grandfather was so courtly, wise and calm:
At times a sweet old wordling, dealing balm
Through business phrase or words of ancient psalm,
Justice and whimsical kindness to all.
As he watched mankind, so in early Fall,
He watched his grape-vines on the stable wall.
In old Quebec the season is too brief
To ripen grapes well ... sometimes scarlet leaf
Becomes a herald swift beyond belief.
The few big clusters with pale purple bloom
So slowly deepening, often met their doom
When rich October caught November's gloom.
He never lost his interest ... every Fall
He saw his grape-vines as he'd dreamed them, all
Weighed down with purple riches, growing tall
Over the stable windows. On the way

To the rose garden where he walked each day ...
“These grapes are riper than last year” he’d say.
In spite of all the travelling he’d done
He sought no changes now and thought “no sun
Could be much brighter than a Canadian one!”
Yet I knew well his grapes brought visions fair
Of mellow summer lands with temperate air.
“Grapes are like men—can’t ripen everywhere....
Men all need sun, and right loam I suppose;
But if one strikes deep roots ... as a rule ... he grows!”
He smiled his smile and cut a late white rose.

RED CURRANTS

“Well! The red currants must be picked to-day.
They’re ready for jelly” Grandmother would say.
She never wasted words yet had her way.
In cool gray cotton gown, and black straw hat
Securely tied—She made a point of that
Though no breeze stirred the lilacs where she sat
To superintend old Jock and Marie Anne
At tasks of picking. When her palm-leaf fan
Waved slowly all was well; but my blood ran
Quicker when it moved very fast ... one knew
The hours were slipping past ... then old Jock too
And Marie Anne, would pick with greater zest.
“Granny! Red currant jelly’s *much* the best!”
“Black’s best for colds” she’d say, as she caressed
With firm kind fingers my rough curly head.
She rarely kissed me. Deep within was bred
Acid reserve and purity ... those red
Ripe currants, with their pleasant acid tang,
Seemed to me just *like* Grandmother! I sang
My multiplication-tables till they rang
Loud through the garden where dear Granny sat
Smiling—well-pleased—with firmly-tied black hat!

AMBER RASPBERRIES

Old Jock and Marie Anne could never find
Raspberries of the glowing amber kind
To fill the “ancient porcelain bowl.” (’Twas lined
With amber glaze; outside a gold vine wound
In such a graceful pattern round and round.)
But if my Mother looked she always found
Enough to fill the bowl. That day we’d three
Distinguished guests. I loved to have them see
My lovely Mother as she looked at tea....
Her gown of creamy lace—her shining hair,
Her beads of old carved amber ... all her rare
Fragile soft richness, like the berries there
With their pale amber bloom. I loved her so....
I wished that every body there could know....
“Why don’t you eat your berries, Child?” ... then low
I bent my head to hide two burning tears
Of yearning love. How strange those vague cold fears
My child heart knew that day ... what long long years
Since those last lovely hours of ecstasy
When she made Beauty live and thrill for me.

Songs of Women

BLUE MOON

OH I was young an' feared o' pain
When I went hot-lovering down the lane.
I sipped sweet honey wi' my red lips,
An' I touched fire wi' my finger-tips,
But I drew them back again—
For the withered, gray woman so old and wise,
Wi' the queer, hushed voice an' the listening eyes,
An' the stone-deaf ears, who lives i' the lane—
She stepped so soft an' she says "Rose-Jane!
You're eating plum porridge (ye poor wee loon!)
Eating it hot in a rare blue moon.
You've a dimpled face like a rosy June,
But your mouth'll be burnt
Before you've learnt
The way of a man in the moon.
And then they'll call you 'Old Rose-Jane
Who went hot-lovering down the lane.'
Beware of the rare blue moon, Rose-Jane!"

Saints bless that woman wi' listening eyes!
I've planted the sweet-briar where she lies.
She stopped my ears an' she made me wise.
I'm pure as the virgin saints are pure—
Now never a man my pale lips lure.
But once in a blue moon, I'm not sure
That the withered gray woman, wi' listening eyes,
Didn't cheat me out of a rare fine prize.

Something calls to me i' the moon,
"Rose-Jane! Rose-Jane! Come! Come soon!"

MISTRESS MARY

“O MISTRESS Mary—Mistress Mary—
What have you found in your new old house?
Paperers are waiting you, and carpenters, and gardeners—
And you are up garret, just as still as a mouse!
What makes your eyes so wet and so round?
Mary—Mary! What have you found?”

“Where the sour old wind grieves under the eaves
There’s an old trunk hid—Oh the dust on the lid!
I pulled out from it a gay round box,
And in it were worn-out boots and socks—
Little, soft socks and little, stout boots—
And a child’s crude drawings of flowers and fruits,
And a tiny toy whip, and a ship and a ball—
Oh—they’re just like a little lost boy! That’s all!”

DAFFY-DOWN-DILLY

'T WAS a green velvet gown
That he wanted me to wear,
With a yellow satin ribbon
In my rough brown hair.

But his flame burned down
And then he turned cold;
And he sent for the Parson,
Who called me bold.

.

So I've come down with my velvet gown
To earn my living in Evil-Town.
But I think I was ever more mad than bad,
And I'd very much rather be good and glad....

.

*Frowsy thing
With a broken wing!
Hark to the queer little songs she'll sing!
Drowsy thing!*

THE BIRTH-NIGHT

THE eerie fingers of the rain
All day have stroked my window-pane,
While all the day and all the night
Elves have been grinding, keen and bright,
Weird, tiny knives of nerves and wits.
Upon my heart an Elf-king sits ...
A cruel, Lilliputian mite ...
And by my breath he flies a kite
Of hope in life or hope in death.
He tugs and scowls with all his might ...
The kite depends on my frail breath.
I watch the earthly colours bright,
Painted upon that fluttering kite.

.

Little boys fly gay kites
And play with marbles ...
Little boys laugh and shout
In the wind and the sunshine....

.

Little Boy ... oh little Boy ... were you ever an Elf-king?

.

The eerie fingers of the rain
All day have stroked my window-pane.

.

Far off I hear a voice explain
“She seems to listen to the rain ...

She *has* put up a plucky fight!
A splendid boy! Oh *she's* all right!"

.

Elves! Elves! Stop your grinding!
Rain! Rain! Stop your stroking!
Bright little kite is gaily flying
In the sky ... for I'm not dying ...
I am alive!... alive!... alive!
Heart and soul and senses five!

.

Now as soon as I can say anything
I'll make them show me that Elfin-king!

A PORTRAIT

FRAIL, exquisite, indomitable face,
Where pain has left its trace ...
Where are the words to paint
Her curious austere charm ... elusive, pure,
As the frost etchings on the window-pane.
Ivory, ebony, lace ...
Yes I shall choose that clinging gown of black,
Severely plain, but with such frills of lace
Over the delicate wrists and blue-veined hands
That for an instant one feels all restraint
Quite useless! Ravishing, ecstatic frills
Of lace, or lacy thrills!
Choose either phrase!
She's no fanatical saint ...
No, after all,
No saint at all!
Come help me, portrait painters rare and old ...
Velasquez, Romney, Reynolds and Van Dyke ...
Here's what you'd like
Poured in a modern, twentieth century mould.
Ivory, ebony, lace ...
Her face
Brings suddenly before me grave and clear,
Impression of an old-time cavalier,
With feminine grace;
Brave glancing sword and delicate ripples of lace.
For she has conquered dragons of old pain
With a deep-shining clarity of thought:
Victorious though her frailty shows the strain.
I trace
With clumsy words the outlines of her face ...
Brave, grave, and suddenly flashing, purely gay,
Like the lace frills at play!

And so you see as I began I end
This portrait of my friend ...
Ivory, ebony, lace ...
Frail, exquisite, indomitable face!

THE SONG OF THE WILLOW WAND

SING hey the green willow
That grows in my valley!
Oh who would climb hill-tops
To see what's beyond!

There came a gipsy vagabond
A-strolling down my valley,
With honey mouth for kissing
And a gown of dusky red.
“So this is how ye spend the days
Wi' never a wind to freshen ye—
Climb up the hill wi' me, my lad,
An' look—see what's beyond!”
She laughed wi' me, and shared sweet bread,
And waved a willow wand.
By green moonlight we climbed the hill
And reached the top at morn,
And then she stood on tip-toe there
And blew a silver horn.
Oh at the other side the hill
Her gipsy lord was waiting there ...
I saw a joyous mating there
That left me all forlorn.
I watched her gown of dusky red
Against the blue horizon ...
Oh that was how I climbed the hill
And saw the world beyond.
I wonder why God let her come
And share sweet bread a-laughing,
And leave a-lying at my feet
Her broken willow wand.

Sing hey the green willow

That grows in my valley!
Oh who would climb hill-tops
To see what's beyond?

THE DEAD VIOLIN

ICICLES ... icicles hang from the eaves
In glittering sheaves,
Over attic windows,
A cold wind heaves
Great, shuddering, gusty sighs; it grieves
For its waning power in the gay March sun,
Whose melting work now is well begun ...
Soft, slow,
Drip, drip,
Soft, slow,
Drop, drop ...
Great icicle tears ...
Glistening, heavy, sun-drenched tears!
Under my roof
Remote, aloof,
Lies this deer-hide trunk with its quaint, brass nails,
Ancient, small ...
How that old wind wails
As I lift the lid to see
What is here for me!
Delightful find!
All carefully, carefully lined
With old old wall-paper, blue and gold!
First I unfold
An Indian shawl ... then a linen sheet ...
Oh ... packets of letters, still faintly sweet ...
“More letters to burn!” I groan, “Dear dear!
But here ... look here!
As I live an old, old violin,
So frail and thin,
And dusky dark in its shapely line;
A shell out-worn; (hear that old wind whine!)
With a cruel gash here at one side,

And the tail-piece torn
And dangling, tied by a piece of twine ...
A dead violin in fine.

.

“We spend our years as a tale that is told”
Violins packed in a poetry mould!
Blue violins that, liquid, pour
Vanished songs on a mystic shore ...
Green violins that ecstatic trill
Like bobolinks, till the year stands still
In a lyrical meadow of green and gold ...
(Violins packed in a poetry mould!)
Red violins of a summer night
Throbbing with passionate, blood-red song ...
Dead violin! Ice-bound so long ...
Soft!
Soft ... drop softly icicle tears ...
Icicle tears from the ice-bound years,
Vibrating under my strong, new roof,
Where the old violin, remote, aloof,
Lies in my hands so terribly dead ...
Never an echo of throbbing red ...
Dead. Dead.

.

I want to bury it where it will rot
In rich warm earth, in a noontide hot,
Under the mightiest tree I know,
And let it again through the tree-roots grow.
I'll fold it close in the soft, old sheet,
Place the letters, still faintly sweet,
Against the gash in its dark-hued side ...
Its the violin—not Love—that died.

A SKETCH

I HEAR him humming as he drives his car,
In mellow baritone, an ancient psalm—
Drifting down to his subtle modern brain
From his old covenanting ancestors,
Who strode bare-kneed through purple heather bloom,
Praising their God on wind-swept Highland hills.
I am his wife. Beside him vividly,
I see now not the crowded city streets,
Through which he presses, strong, aloof and calm,
Factories and shipyards where his vast machines
Whirr steadfastly, obedient to his brain—
I see now just those small and golden hours
When he is mine.

Cinquains

CITY CHILD'S EASTER

FRAGRANCE

Of Hot Cross Buns:

Pots of white lilies: sunshine: magic eggs:

New skipping-ropes—but old old winds

Of Faith.

DEEP SNOW

POWDER

Of diamond

Upon a silver birch;

Old stone wall

Buried deep.

And you ...

A scarlet bird

Whose wild wings flutter here

Against my soul. How still

The world!

HOKKU

*“‘Hokku’ (seventeen-syllable poem) in Japanese mind might be compared with a tiny star, I dare say, carrying the whole sky at its back. It is like a slightly-open door, where you may steal into the realm of poesy. It is simply a guiding lamp. Its value depends on how much it suggests.”

(Yone Noguchi, from *The Pilgrimage*,
published by Elkin Mathews, London, Eng.)

TWELVE HOKKU ON A CANADIAN THEME

(1)

HOW strangely they float,
Pale gold and ivory cups,
On wilderness lakes.

(2)

The loon's weird laughter
Holds Indian deviltry,
Long, long forgotten.

(3)

Indian cradle
Swung from bough, rocked by Four Winds:
Christ lay in manger.

(4)

Silver-haired Marquise!
You were transplanted, one Spring,
Into wild New France.

(5)

The sugar maples ...
Benevolent goddesses
Who offer honey.

(6)

Snow-shoes: like strong wings
Bound on the feet of victors
Conquering snow-fields.

(7)

On city pavements
Two muffled, sombre nuns pace,
Behind laughing girls.

(8)

You set narcissus
Amidst your silver birches
By Northern lakeside.

(9)

Five o'clock! You pause ...
Handle frail, old cups, pour tea,
And become grande dame.

(10)

When Loneliness stalked ...
Black panther through gold wheat-fields ...
You used Love's arrows.

(11)

Puissant woman!...
Sheltering tiny things like
English primroses!

(12)

Fast the new trails lead
From wilderness to city!
Years pass ... Canada!

LIFE SEQUENCE

(In The Hokku Manner)

(UNREADY)

Close-folded fern ...
So stiff; so coldly self-sustained:
But summer passes.

(Motherhood)

Puss watches the world,
Troubled: but knows she is linked
To a miracle.

(Home)

Empty room; fire dies;
Moon shines in; chairs and tables converse;
Books croon songs.

(Awakening)

Gray old tree
Has breasted winter storms; but is vaguely
Worried by March.

(Memorial Tablet)

Sunshine on storied bronze:
Love on the whirling earth:
And you on my heart.

PRAYER IN SCARLET AND WHITE PAINT

THERE is a marvellous washing
creamy and snowy-white
hung high on lines
stretched from upper and lower balconies
in the back-yard, across the narrow lane
behind my rusty apple-tree
and dusty lilac hedge;
and a great splendid 'woman-by-the-day'
comely and fat, with a bronzed skin
and tumbled blue black hair,
and an ugly and joyous scarlet gown,
is hanging out the clothes ...
wet heavy clean white clothes ...
soft liquid splashes of light amidst dull dusty trees
and sombre dirty bricks.
The laden lines begin to ripple seductively
in the cool sour east wind.
There is no sun to-day,
but the great splashes of high-hung white,
the competent brown arms,
the comfortable strength in vivid scarlet ...
they have given me the warmth and wonder
and the refreshment
of tumbling woodland waters
and blazing sun.
I thank you ... Life!
I daub it in on a bit of canvas
(with a copy of a Botticelli madonna on the other side!)
so I may remember
the sordid back lane has become quite immaterial ...
I thank you ... Life!

Cold Tragedy

COLD TRAGEDY

FLORENCE

HOW this old terrace of mellow, creamy stone
Grows warm in this noontide sun of Italy ...
I sit alone
And dream a piteous dream of ecstasy
And suddenly wake!
In that raw town by a Canadian lake
Does she pause now ... to watch the falling snow?
Before me stretch the olive trees that glow
With their soft silvery radiance; far below
The towers of Florence rise, like tall carved flowers.
Ah I know well she does not count her hours
That swiftly pass from dawn to candle-light ...
She has the sun-filled day ...
I but the night!

VENICE

Dense violet sky of sparkling stars above,
And all around
The soft, mysterious stirring of dark velvet water
That makes no sound.
And here in the old Square
Life ... surging, swaying, sparkling everywhere,
As if it held at arms' length waiting there
The sky and water and their mysteries.
But near me at a little table alone,
A red-haired, black-eyed woman broods and waits,
Gazing across the empty cups and plates.
Her bright hair makes a glory in the light,
But her dark eyes, unseeing, bring the night,
Too near!

ROME

So ... only the little things are left to me ...
Cold comforts they!... Beauty my only home.
Drifting of almond bloom ... gray ruins of Rome ...
The Italian sun that makes these old stones warm ...
Lilt of old poems ... sight of a girlish form ...
Gay little laughter ... moon through the cypress trees ...
I occupy myself quite well with these.

Homespun

TWINS

(The old Housekeeper speaks)

I'VE seen a good deal in my life.
My own story was over you see
Pretty young—
But I've danced an' I've sung
In my day with the best.
I've been blest
With the love of a fine brave man,
An' a babe at my breast.
But now that's all past,
An' I've got a good home that'll last
(An annuity too)
Till old Mr. Drayton an' I
Get through!
What d'ye say?
Hmmm—
It's funny you like to hear me talk,
An' drop in like this on your afternoon walk.
Now you want to know—don't you?—
Yes yes— —
This last queer thing that's happened!
I guess
You'll like it because you like cats!
Well—last night
With the fire burnin' bright
I was sittin' an' knittin'
An' watchin' the kitten
An' the old mother cat.
I sat
Here; an' there by the table a-readin'
As usual—a-readin' as if he was feedin'
His stomach an' soul,
Sat old Mr. Drayton—as droll

An' dried up an old sinner
As ever took dinner
With his book by his plate,
Readin' early an' late,
With his shinin' bald head an' its mole.
But he does love a kitten—
An' likes me here knittin'—
Poor soul!
Well all of a sudden the bell rang.
I went just as spry as I could
But I thought die I should
When I opened the door
An' I saw standin' there
In the hall lamp's red glare
Another old Drayton—as like as two peas—
The one at the table behind me a-readin'
An' here on the step number Two stood—a-kneadin'
His long pointed chin
With his skinny old hand.
But he says very bland—
A-stickin' his eye glass up tight in his eye,
With the black ribbon danglin'
“My good woman—I
Am your master's twin brother.
Mr. Drayton is in?”
An' all I could say like a booby was
“Twin? Twin brother—twin brother—
Oh Luddy! Twin? Twin!”
Then *my* Drayton spoke
An' I almost jumped out of my skin—
With his dry old voice
Just like an echo—
“I'm in.
Twin.”
Then he says “Mrs. Beaton! Stay here!”
I tell you I felt queer.
There they sat by the fire

With the table between,
Just eyein' each other—
Twin brother—twin brother—
Both babes of one mother.
The old cat humped an' spit on my knees
An' run off with a sneeze.
Then said he—the new Drayton—
“Well Richard she's dead!
Kittie's dead—
And the last words she said
Were ‘Now Rob you make up with him Dear.’
So Richard—I'm here.”
But my Drayton sat quiet—
Poor, shrivelled, dear soul
With his mole.
An' I noticed the other was lackin' the mole
But otherwise—My! They are certainly twins!
“Yes” said Drayton, “You're in
My house, Twin.
So she thought Bitter Past
Can be sweetened at last!
Pretty thin!”
An' the light on his mole
Seemed to shrivel his soul.
You'd have heard it if I'd dropped a pin.
Then they sat an' they sat an' they sat.
I could see it was flat
That somethin' would *have* to be done
Or there'd nothin' be won
For either. I felt as if maybe we'd sit
Till Eternity come
Or till I had a fit!
For with chins like theirs set—
I was in a cold sweat
I can tell you. I took up my knittin'
To just die there—sittin'
When sudden that kitten

She just took a glance
An' made one funny prance
Up that table at Drayton—
The new one—She put up her paw
An' she patted his danglin' black ribbon.
Oh Law—an' he had to hold tight
To his eyeglass to fix it safe into his eye.
Then if she didn't try
To get at it again
An' she sat up an' blinked
In his face for a minute—the man never winked.
Then she played with her tail
Right under his chin—
Just a gray ball of fur
With two eyes an' a purr.
An' the light that was caught
In his great signet ring,
She saw that an' patted it—cute little thing—
An' she licked all his hand with her little pink tongue,
An' then back to my Drayton
As if she'd been stung!
A-curlin' right up on his shoulder an' purrin'
The only live thing in the room that was stirrin'.
Oh I tell you that kitten was more than just—cat!
Love was usin' that kitten,
I felt sure of that.
Back an' forth she went playin'
Between those old twins
An' the room still so quiet you might have heard pins
A-droppin'. I burst right out.
“Luddy” I said “You two men! Why that kitten's
Possessed of the dead!
If you could just see yourselves sittin' up there
Like two graven images—each on a chair—
An' that little kitten a-tryin' to play
With you both—I'm clean crazy!
I *will* go away!”

I just shrieked it out an' they both spoke at once—
“Now now my good woman—
Come don't be a dunce!”
An' I said
“Well I'm neither a dunce nor—a twin!
But if there's names goin' why I'll just begin
An' I'll say you're twin dunces!”
Then sudden I saw
Them both smile—at the kitten!
It felt like a thaw
After ice—up in Greenland.

Oh yes—they're both well.
An' the comfort they're takin'
I've no words to tell.

BOB COONING

“BOB Cooning the giant’s come home to die”—
So the village folk say
To-day.
They shake their heads and they peer and spy,
And they draw in their breaths—
“Dear—Dear!” they sigh;
And they cook him dainties
And wonder why
The Lord ever made, under His kind sky,
Bob Cooning!

Bob Cooning the giant was only a boy,
Like Harry or Tom or Jim or Dick,
But one that the other boys couldn’t lick.
Never a clean fair fight for Bob
As boy to boy. “That’s a dirty trick—
To hit a fellow just half your size!”
I’ve seen the tears in Bob’s big blue eyes.
“Give me a man to fight!” he’d say,
And they’d jeer—“You’ll keep till another day!”
Poor Bob would turn and slouch from the place
And lie face down in tall “Queen Anne’s lace”
And sob and sob to the cool brown earth,
Far off from the sound of his playmates’ mirth—
Poor Bob Cooning!

And he could not learn to cipher or read,
And he felt himself of a different breed.
He ate so much, and his clothes cost more
Than any one else, till his father swore.
He slouched and stooped through the highest door.
His poor little mother wailed and cried—
But his wise old Granny only sighed

“It’s the good God made him an’ He’ll provide.”
How Bob Cooning cried when his Granny died!

Then one night when the village was racked and thrilled
With the circus tents, and the beast cries shrilled
From the hot green meadow, Bob Cooning went
With a sharp-faced man to a certain tent.
Tom, Harry and Dick saw the last gay train
Pull out, but they never saw Bob again
Until, one day, through our old church door,
At the morning service, strode Bob once more
With his head thrown back, and a smile as bland
As the great glass ring on his vast pink hand.
How the people young and old did grin
As the handsome giant came walking in
With his sporty suit of a fine light check,
And the great starched collar about his neck!
How he dwarfed our poor little house of God!
Dr. Smitters was preaching on Aaron’s rod,
And how it budded in miracle bloom.
“Say! With Bob in a church there ain’t hardly room
For us and the minister both!” So Jim
The wag, so dapper and keen and slim
Whispered to Pollie—but Pollie just sighed.
“Oh my, but Bob’s splendid!” Pollie replied.
That winter Bob Cooning was just like a king!
His father boasted “A darn fine thing
For us, that our son went away that day!
I tell you he’s made the show business pay.
He’s heaps of cash an’ he says he’ll stay
Here a while—but he may go any day.”
When the glamour wore off the wise heads said
“He’s stupid as ever, with wits like lead.”
And more than one mother wished he’d go—
“So handsome—he does turn the girls’ heads so!”
And finally, all in the sweet green May,
He went off again on a “Circus Day.”

And when he came back for the second time—
This *isn't* a story to put in rhyme—
Now is it?—And yet if the Lord saw fit
To make a giant and jest a bit
Right out here in our country-side
With every one seeing him far and wide—
Well it seems to me that a rhyme goes fine
For this pitiful, circus-like tale of mine—
Of giant Bob and his coming home
Never again with his shows to roam.
“He’s fadin’ out like a wisp o’ hay”
Said his poor little mother to me to-day.
“He smiles at me an’ says ‘Ma—I’m small!
An’ I always thought I was awful tall!’
An’ he’s just as happy as he can be
When he thinks he’s a wee boy—deary me!”
And I said “Mrs. Cooning—now don’t you fret.
I guess God will know how to handle him yet.”
And she said “Well—he *has* been a famous man
In them shows!”—So—we all do the best we can.
He’s a terrible problem to bathe and lift,
But we’ve got it arranged, in a “double shift.”

Bob Cooning, the giant, has come home to die.
And the God that made him—
He must know why!

SYMPATHY

THAT ugly pumpkin-coloured house
That I saw from the train—
I have wondered about the minds of the people inside
But I wonder in vain.
Did they *choose* that paint?
Or perhaps it was brought them to buy—
Oh I hope now they've got it all done that they like it—
And don't just have to try.
Oh I hope that it shines there for them
In their sunny green fields
Like a lantern at night—
And I hope that on dull rainy days they both say to each other
“*Don't* it look nice and bright?”

Oh I think I shall never forget them
In their new-painted house!

FALSE DAWN

(1)

MY apple trees have blossomed in a night,
And pale green moonlight bathes their rose and white
With a strange wine that makes the pulses throb.
A sleepy robin now mistakes the light,
And his soft doubting note sounds like a sob
Voicing the thought that draws my heart-strings tight.

(2)

What Life could give you is not yours to take
Nor mine to give—and yet to-night I wake
Remembering your giving. But the note
Of that moon-haunted robin must not shake
My calm belief that you—austere, remote—
Need nothing I can ever mar or make.

THE WITCH

THEY—the good people—heard her song
From out of the wood that grows thick in the valley.
She had climbed to the hill-top that rises, blue,
Out of the wood as one comes through.
Grass on the hill-top waving long,
And a smooth gray stone where she kept her tally
Of the years and the days in the wild singing wood.
She lived her life as a virgin should
Till the people heard her song.
They climbed the hill and they frowned and said
“We liked your songs that we heard in the valley.
We don’t like that one you are singing to-day!
It’s mad and it’s bad and it’s much too gay!
But we’ve brought you some meat and bread.”
Then they saw on the stone her tally,
And they shook their heads ... “Look here! Look here!
Oh it’s very very plain she is queer ... mad queer!”
And they took her away on that self-same day,
Though she fought till she lay half-dead.
Now all she had written on the smooth gray stone
Were the strange magic things (O the deep blue wings!)
That happen in a wild, singing wood.
But they said “She hasn’t lived as a virgin should ...
When she dies she shall lie on the hill for good.”
And they laid her there, with her soft black hair
Strained back from her dead white brow.
“We will set at her head for a tombstone now
This stone where she kept mad tally!”
But she laughed as she sped from that hill-top bed
And roamed through the wood and the valley ...
 “Oh wild blue wings I am free” (sang she)
 “Now I own the singing wood and the wood owns me,
 Oh the hill-top too and the valley!

They gave back my stone and they've left me alone ...
I am free! I am free! I am free!"

THE POST BOX

THERE is something very wonderful
In the posting of a letter—
So few acts have the clarity of this.
A clear-cut, forceful and far-reaching act
Of pain or bliss,
So it may be:
Irrevocable in the subtlest way—
To-day—
You see?
The post box flashes red
A sign and seal of dominating law
Through April green, or hard and glittering white
Of winter snow.
One may have vacillated day and night,
Longing to end the turmoil, stress and strain,
Questioning what is best or wise or right—
And then post box gleams red!
Cutting clean through the world of indecision
Like a shout
Of triumph!
Then a soft flat thud—
Like tiny echo floating out
From a beyond of peace.

The letter falls—
Decisive act, prisoned in four red walls.

SONG

DEW ...

Delicate lanterns, star-kindled anew,

And a sword of silver

Brave, shining and still ...

With roses—deep roses of crimson—

And, sheathing the blade,

Greek hyacinths blue.

Ah ... the treasures, the symbols, we laid

In the deep cold mould on the hill

With the body of you!...

But over the mould there flew

Something wingéd that earth could not hold—

You!...

BREAD AND FIRE

BELOVED Friend,

I write this verse to you
As if it were a letter I could send.
It seems to me sometimes my heart slips through
The purple barriers between us two,
And finds again your fire, your sacred bread:
Their warmth and wholesome sweetness ...
Fire and Bread!

Beloved, these symbols nourish Life anew ...
You are not dead!

“MOMENT MUSICAL”

BLUE moth!...
Tiny, pulsating thing ...
You and I met upon a rocky hill.
I paused ...
You paused, and poised
Blue,
Blue on a dark stone:
And all the vibrant sunshine in the world
Was caught for the sparkle
On your tiny wings ...
Blue moth!



Transcriber's Notes

Obvious typographical errors have been silently corrected. Variations in hyphenation and accents have been standardised but all other spelling and punctuation remains unchanged.

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK DREAM
TAPESTRIES ***

Updated editions will replace the previous one—the old editions will be renamed.

Creating the works from print editions not protected by U.S. copyright law means that no one owns a United States copyright in these works, so the Foundation (and you!) can copy and distribute it in the United States without permission and without paying copyright royalties. Special rules, set forth in the General Terms of Use part of this license, apply to copying and distributing Project Gutenberg™ electronic works to protect the PROJECT GUTENBERG™ concept and trademark. Project Gutenberg is a registered trademark, and may not be used if you charge for an eBook, except by following the terms of the trademark license, including paying royalties for use of the Project Gutenberg trademark. If you do not charge anything for copies of this eBook, complying with the trademark license is very easy. You may use this eBook for nearly any purpose such as creation of derivative works, reports, performances and research. Project Gutenberg eBooks may be modified and printed and given away—you may do practically ANYTHING in the United States with eBooks not protected by U.S. copyright law. Redistribution is subject to the trademark license, especially commercial redistribution.

START: FULL LICENSE

THE FULL PROJECT GUTENBERG™ LICENSE

PLEASE READ THIS BEFORE YOU DISTRIBUTE OR USE THIS WORK

To protect the Project Gutenberg™ mission of promoting the free distribution of electronic works, by using or distributing this work (or any other work associated in any way with the phrase “Project Gutenberg”), you agree to comply with all the terms of the Full Project Gutenberg License available with this file or online at www.gutenberg.org/license.

Section 1. General Terms of Use and Redistributing Project Gutenberg electronic works

1.A. By reading or using any part of this Project Gutenberg electronic work, you indicate that you have read, understand, agree to and accept all the terms of this license and intellectual property (trademark/copyright) agreement. If you do not agree to abide by all the terms of this agreement, you must cease using and return or destroy all copies of Project Gutenberg electronic works in your possession. If you paid a fee for obtaining a copy of or access to a Project Gutenberg electronic work and you do not agree to be bound by the terms of this agreement, you may obtain a refund from the person or entity to whom you paid the fee as set forth in paragraph 1.E.8.

1.B. “Project Gutenberg” is a registered trademark. It may only be used on or associated in any way with an electronic work by people who agree to be bound by the terms of this agreement. There are a few things that you can do with most Project Gutenberg electronic works even without complying with the full terms of this agreement. See paragraph 1.C below. There are a lot of things you can do with Project Gutenberg electronic works if you follow the terms of this agreement and help preserve free future access to Project Gutenberg electronic works. See paragraph 1.E below.

1.C. The Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation (“the Foundation” or PGLAF), owns a compilation copyright in the

collection of Project Gutenberg electronic works. Nearly all the individual works in the collection are in the public domain in the United States. If an individual work is unprotected by copyright law in the United States and you are located in the United States, we do not claim a right to prevent you from copying, distributing, performing, displaying or creating derivative works based on the work as long as all references to Project Gutenberg are removed. Of course, we hope that you will support the Project Gutenberg mission of promoting free access to electronic works by freely sharing Project Gutenberg works in compliance with the terms of this agreement for keeping the Project Gutenberg name associated with the work. You can easily comply with the terms of this agreement by keeping this work in the same format with its attached full Project Gutenberg License when you share it without charge with others.

1.D. The copyright laws of the place where you are located also govern what you can do with this work. Copyright laws in most countries are in a constant state of change. If you are outside the United States, check the laws of your country in addition to the terms of this agreement before downloading, copying, displaying, performing, distributing or creating derivative works based on this work or any other Project Gutenberg work. The Foundation makes no representations concerning the copyright status of any work in any country other than the United States.

1.E. Unless you have removed all references to Project Gutenberg:

1.E.1. The following sentence, with active links to, or other immediate access to, the full Project Gutenberg License must appear prominently whenever any copy of a Project Gutenberg work (any work on which the phrase “Project Gutenberg” appears, or with which the phrase “Project Gutenberg” is associated) is accessed, displayed, performed, viewed, copied or distributed:

This eBook is for the use of anyone anywhere in the United States and most other parts of the world at no cost and with almost no restrictions whatsoever. You may copy it, give it away or re-use it under the terms of the Project Gutenberg™ License included with

this eBook or online at www.gutenberg.org. If you are not located in the United States, you will have to check the laws of the country where you are located before using this eBook.

1.E.2. If an individual Project Gutenberg electronic work is derived from texts not protected by U.S. copyright law (does not contain a notice indicating that it is posted with permission of the copyright holder), the work can be copied and distributed to anyone in the United States without paying any fees or charges. If you are redistributing or providing access to a work with the phrase “Project Gutenberg” associated with or appearing on the work, you must comply either with the requirements of paragraphs 1.E.1 through 1.E.7 or obtain permission for the use of the work and the Project Gutenberg trademark as set forth in paragraphs 1.E.8 or 1.E.9.

1.E.3. If an individual Project Gutenberg electronic work is posted with the permission of the copyright holder, your use and distribution must comply with both paragraphs 1.E.1 through 1.E.7 and any additional terms imposed by the copyright holder. Additional terms will be linked to the Project Gutenberg License for all works posted with the permission of the copyright holder found at the beginning of this work.

1.E.4. Do not unlink or detach or remove the full Project Gutenberg License terms from this work, or any files containing a part of this work or any other work associated with Project Gutenberg.

1.E.5. Do not copy, display, perform, distribute or redistribute this electronic work, or any part of this electronic work, without prominently displaying the sentence set forth in paragraph 1.E.1 with active links or immediate access to the full terms of the Project Gutenberg License.

1.E.6. You may convert to and distribute this work in any binary, compressed, marked up, nonproprietary or proprietary form, including any word processing or hypertext form. However, if you provide access to or distribute copies of a Project Gutenberg work in a format other than “Plain Vanilla ASCII” or other format used in the official

version posted on the official Project Gutenberg website (www.gutenberg.org), you must, at no additional cost, fee or expense to the user, provide a copy, a means of exporting a copy, or a means of obtaining a copy upon request, of the work in its original “Plain Vanilla ASCII” or other form. Any alternate format must include the full Project Gutenberg License as specified in paragraph 1.E.1.

1.E.7. Do not charge a fee for access to, viewing, displaying, performing, copying or distributing any Project Gutenberg works unless you comply with paragraph 1.E.8 or 1.E.9.

1.E.8. You may charge a reasonable fee for copies of or providing access to or distributing Project Gutenberg electronic works provided that:

- You pay a royalty fee of 20% of the gross profits you derive from the use of Project Gutenberg works calculated using the method you already use to calculate your applicable taxes. The fee is owed to the owner of the Project Gutenberg trademark, but he has agreed to donate royalties under this paragraph to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation. Royalty payments must be paid within 60 days following each date on which you prepare (or are legally required to prepare) your periodic tax returns. Royalty payments should be clearly marked as such and sent to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation at the address specified in Section 4, “Information about donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation.”
- You provide a full refund of any money paid by a user who notifies you in writing (or by e-mail) within 30 days of receipt that s/he does not agree to the terms of the full Project Gutenberg™ License. You must require such a user to return or destroy all copies of the works possessed in a physical medium and discontinue all use of and all access to other copies of Project Gutenberg™ works.
- You provide, in accordance with paragraph 1.F.3, a full refund of any money paid for a work or a replacement copy, if a defect in the electronic work is discovered and reported to you within 90 days of receipt of the work.

- You comply with all other terms of this agreement for free distribution of Project Gutenberg™ works.

1.E.9. If you wish to charge a fee or distribute a Project Gutenberg™ electronic work or group of works on different terms than are set forth in this agreement, you must obtain permission in writing from the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, the manager of the Project Gutenberg™ trademark. Contact the Foundation as set forth in Section 3 below.

1.F.

1.F.1. Project Gutenberg volunteers and employees expend considerable effort to identify, do copyright research on, transcribe and proofread works not protected by U.S. copyright law in creating the Project Gutenberg™ collection. Despite these efforts, Project Gutenberg™ electronic works, and the medium on which they may be stored, may contain “Defects,” such as, but not limited to, incomplete, inaccurate or corrupt data, transcription errors, a copyright or other intellectual property infringement, a defective or damaged disk or other medium, a computer virus, or computer codes that damage or cannot be read by your equipment.

1.F.2. LIMITED WARRANTY, DISCLAIMER OF DAMAGES - Except for the “Right of Replacement or Refund” described in paragraph 1.F.3, the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, the owner of the Project Gutenberg™ trademark, and any other party distributing a Project Gutenberg™ electronic work under this agreement, disclaim all liability to you for damages, costs and expenses, including legal fees. YOU AGREE THAT YOU HAVE NO REMEDIES FOR NEGLIGENCE, STRICT LIABILITY, BREACH OF WARRANTY OR BREACH OF CONTRACT EXCEPT THOSE PROVIDED IN PARAGRAPH 1.F.3. YOU AGREE THAT THE FOUNDATION, THE TRADEMARK OWNER, AND ANY DISTRIBUTOR UNDER THIS AGREEMENT WILL NOT BE LIABLE TO YOU FOR ACTUAL, DIRECT, INDIRECT, CONSEQUENTIAL, PUNITIVE OR INCIDENTAL DAMAGES

EVEN IF YOU GIVE NOTICE OF THE POSSIBILITY OF SUCH DAMAGE.

1.F.3. LIMITED RIGHT OF REPLACEMENT OR REFUND - If you discover a defect in this electronic work within 90 days of receiving it, you can receive a refund of the money (if any) you paid for it by sending a written explanation to the person you received the work from. If you received the work on a physical medium, you must return the medium with your written explanation. The person or entity that provided you with the defective work may elect to provide a replacement copy in lieu of a refund. If you received the work electronically, the person or entity providing it to you may choose to give you a second opportunity to receive the work electronically in lieu of a refund. If the second copy is also defective, you may demand a refund in writing without further opportunities to fix the problem.

1.F.4. Except for the limited right of replacement or refund set forth in paragraph 1.F.3, this work is provided to you 'AS-IS', WITH NO OTHER WARRANTIES OF ANY KIND, EXPRESS OR IMPLIED, INCLUDING BUT NOT LIMITED TO WARRANTIES OF MERCHANTABILITY OR FITNESS FOR ANY PURPOSE.

1.F.5. Some states do not allow disclaimers of certain implied warranties or the exclusion or limitation of certain types of damages. If any disclaimer or limitation set forth in this agreement violates the law of the state applicable to this agreement, the agreement shall be interpreted to make the maximum disclaimer or limitation permitted by the applicable state law. The invalidity or unenforceability of any provision of this agreement shall not void the remaining provisions.

1.F.6. INDEMNITY - You agree to indemnify and hold the Foundation, the trademark owner, any agent or employee of the Foundation, anyone providing copies of Project Gutenberg™ electronic works in accordance with this agreement, and any volunteers associated with the production, promotion and distribution of Project Gutenberg™ electronic works, harmless from all liability, costs and expenses, including legal fees, that arise directly or indirectly from any of the following which you do or cause to occur: (a)

distribution of this or any Project Gutenberg work, (b) alteration, modification, or additions or deletions to any Project Gutenberg work, and (c) any Defect you cause.

Section 2. Information about the Mission of Project Gutenberg

Project Gutenberg is synonymous with the free distribution of electronic works in formats readable by the widest variety of computers including obsolete, old, middle-aged and new computers. It exists because of the efforts of hundreds of volunteers and donations from people in all walks of life.

Volunteers and financial support to provide volunteers with the assistance they need are critical to reaching Project Gutenberg's goals and ensuring that the Project Gutenberg collection will remain freely available for generations to come. In 2001, the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation was created to provide a secure and permanent future for Project Gutenberg and future generations. To learn more about the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation and how your efforts and donations can help, see Sections 3 and 4 and the Foundation information page at www.gutenberg.org.

Section 3. Information about the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation

The Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation is a non-profit 501(c)(3) educational corporation organized under the laws of the state of Mississippi and granted tax exempt status by the Internal Revenue Service. The Foundation's EIN or federal tax identification number is 64-6221541. Contributions to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation are tax deductible to the full extent permitted by U.S. federal laws and your state's laws.

The Foundation's business office is located at 41 Watchung Plaza #516, Montclair NJ 07042, USA, +1 (862) 621-9288. Email contact

links and up to date contact information can be found at the Foundation's website and official page at www.gutenberg.org/contact

Section 4. Information about Donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation

Project Gutenberg™ depends upon and cannot survive without widespread public support and donations to carry out its mission of increasing the number of public domain and licensed works that can be freely distributed in machine-readable form accessible by the widest array of equipment including outdated equipment. Many small donations (\$1 to \$5,000) are particularly important to maintaining tax exempt status with the IRS.

The Foundation is committed to complying with the laws regulating charities and charitable donations in all 50 states of the United States. Compliance requirements are not uniform and it takes a considerable effort, much paperwork and many fees to meet and keep up with these requirements. We do not solicit donations in locations where we have not received written confirmation of compliance. To SEND DONATIONS or determine the status of compliance for any particular state visit www.gutenberg.org/donate.

While we cannot and do not solicit contributions from states where we have not met the solicitation requirements, we know of no prohibition against accepting unsolicited donations from donors in such states who approach us with offers to donate.

International donations are gratefully accepted, but we cannot make any statements concerning tax treatment of donations received from outside the United States. U.S. laws alone swamp our small staff.

Please check the Project Gutenberg web pages for current donation methods and addresses. Donations are accepted in a number of other ways including checks, online payments and credit card donations. To donate, please visit: www.gutenberg.org/donate.

Section 5. General Information About Project Gutenberg electronic works

Professor Michael S. Hart was the originator of the Project Gutenberg concept of a library of electronic works that could be freely shared with anyone. For forty years, he produced and distributed Project Gutenberg eBooks with only a loose network of volunteer support.

Project Gutenberg eBooks are often created from several printed editions, all of which are confirmed as not protected by copyright in the U.S. unless a copyright notice is included. Thus, we do not necessarily keep eBooks in compliance with any particular paper edition.

Most people start at our website which has the main PG search facility: www.gutenberg.org.

This website includes information about Project Gutenberg, including how to make donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, how to help produce our new eBooks, and how to subscribe to our email newsletter to hear about new eBooks.